



Delaware County Council Meeting July 28th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1aASvLzUiBk
Publication Date	2020-07-28T18:46:45Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: July 28, 2020

Meeting Time: 9:00 AM

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Scott Alexander called the Delaware County Council meeting to order at approximately 9:00 AM on July 28, 2020. Public comments were directed to an established county council email address due to ongoing COVID-19 restrictions.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Alexander (Presiding Officer).
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Alexander.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jessica.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes were approved via roll call vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:26 Coroner Budget Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Coroner's Office / Department Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer request moving \$6,000 to Part-Time (133) and reducing Autopsy Lab (311) by \$6,000 (Net zero impact).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:04:01 Communications Department Position Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lauren De Abrams (Representing 9-1-1; Director Paul Singleton on sick leave).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to transfer two recently hired part-time employees into full-time positions to aid faster training and improve employee retention in the 9-1-1 dispatch center.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:06:07 Emergency Management Agency (EMA) Restructuring Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Catino (New EMA Director) / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Splitting the former combined EMA/EMS position back into standalone EMA and separate lines. Introduces John Catino as EMA Director and Corey Kissy (formerly 9-1-1, Albany Fire/Police, Hazmat) as Deputy Director. Net-zero budget transfer.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:07:49 Title IV-D Court Budget Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Title IV-D Court Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$1,570 into Insurance (175) offset by a \$1,570 reduction in Travel Expense (323). Net-zero change.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:08:26 Public Defender's Office Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$900 from line 399 to line 311 (Autopsy lab/supplies line equivalent context). Net-zero change.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:09:05 Family Support Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Family Support Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$10,500 into line 109 offset by a \$10,500 reduction. Net-zero change.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:09:36 Jail Department Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Budget adjustments involving Corrections Officer lines (\$15,457.90 shifts) and administrative lines (\$12,624.20 shifts). Net-zero impact.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:10:33 GIS Department Reorganization & Title Change**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kyle (GIS / Information Services Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following the departure of a GIS technician in June, Kyle proposed reorganizing the department in response to pandemic-driven information management demands. The position title "GIS Coordinator" is officially updated to "Chief Information Officer" (CIO) to reflect broader web, social media, and data dashboard responsibilities. Includes a contractual service line addition to hire an outside vendor for property parcel boundary maintenance. Net-zero request for current year, with projected future savings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:17:28 Jail Additional Line Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$16,762.75 between lines 112 (net-zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:18:18 Clerk's Office Addendum Transfers (Filing Clerk & Voter Registration)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Clerk's Office Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requests to fill/fund a filing clerk position for court records and a deputy registration clerk position in voter registration ahead of a projected high-turnover/high-volume election cycle. Staff noted staffing levels are down from previous years while workloads increase.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
(Note: Accompanied by a commitment to amend the hiring freeze resolution at the end of the meeting).
- **00:21:16 9-1-1 Communications Budget Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications Department / Jane.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments across communication technician lines, education incentives, and overtime (\$16,618.70 added to overtime). Net-zero request.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:22:14 Jail School/Training Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy Marvin (Sheriff's Office Office Manager).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocating unused training/school funds due to COVID-19 cancellations to cover a longevity/salary "roll-in" adjustment for an individual employee whose adjustment was missed during prior standardized longevity implementation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:25:21 9-1-1 Supervisor Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 9-1-1 Communications.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Supervisor line transfer of \$16,379.33 (net-zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).

- **00:26:04 EMS Education Incentive Pay**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley (EMS Interim Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$6,923 to fund educational incentive pay for four paramedics who met eligibility benchmarks. Council and Director Ashley praised EMS staff dedication, noting heavy COVID-19 exposure contacts, recoveries, and stepping up without forced overtime.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:33:02 EMS Capital Improvement Equipment Repair**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley (EMS Interim Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$11,506 to replace a failed, gigantic 80,000-watt manual transfer switch/air conditioner generator system at Station 1 that currently requires manual outdoor operation during storms.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:35:16 Surveyor Perpetuation Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Small \$10 transfer for short/long-term disability line (net-zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:35:50 Assessor / Chief Settlement Deputy Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Assessor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$2,000 into Chief Settlement Deputy line 103 (net-zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:36:33 Platinum Maintenance Copier Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Maintenance Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$3,000 for copier maintenance (net-zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:37:06 Omnibus Financial Transfer & Hiring Freeze Amendment Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Donna Patterson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formal motion to approve all preceding financial transfers and formally amend Resolution 2020-0-15 (Hiring Freeze compliance and salary ordinance reductions).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:38:04 Board Appointment (Lafayette Pegues)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Anitra Davis.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appointment of Lafayette Pegues to fill an unexpired term on a county board following the passing of a previous member.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:40:40 Resolution 2020-031: Fair Board Appropriation Reduction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna (Fair Board) / Commissioners.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Reduction of appropriations to the Fair Board due to the cancellation of the full public county fair caused by COVID-19, wiping out core revenue. The 4-H livestock/exhibitor-only exhibition successfully occurred under strict health department guidelines, a wristband system, and a virtual option managed by Purdue Extension (Molly). The Fair Board secured a \$15,800 PPP loan for salaries/utilities and is seeking fall fundraising events to survive financially into next year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **00:49:01 EMS Position Title Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley (EMS Interim Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administrative restructuring of EMS lines instead of creating new numbering codes: updating Line 104 (Deputy Director Paramedic) to Executive Director, and Line 178 (Paramedic) to Deputy Director.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:55:27 Anitra Davis** (Muncie City Council Member)
 - Addressed the council regarding systemic racism, noting that racism can covertly impact economic development project placements and fiscal decisions made by local legislative bodies. She shared a personal anecdote about changing her name early in her career to secure employment and urged the Delaware County Council to join the City Council in formally condemning racism on all fronts.
-

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reports from the Visitors Bureau indicate \$245,000 collected year-to-date, though hit hard by lodging and food/tax reductions. The Convention Center was commended for safely hosting distanced Chamber of Commerce lunches.
 - The State Budget Agency announced a property tax maximum levy growth quotient of 4.2% for the upcoming budget year.
 - Auditor Donna Patterson noted potential short-term borrowing from the rainy day fund or tax replacement fund ahead of September's rare three-pay month.
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn made by Ryan, seconded by Jessica. Officially adjourned following a roll call vote.
-